Automations

See related

No related articles

Understanding how automations process chat attachments

Last Update: Oct 2026 • Est. Read Time: 6 MIN

To check plan availability, see the pricing page.

Automations are able to receive and process attachments, including images and documents. See Understanding attachment size limits for. more details on size limits by channel.

This list shows all currently supported file types:

- CSV (Copilot only)
- GIF
- JPG
- PNG
- Markdown
- PDF (Copilot only)
- TXT (Copilot only)

Powered by Kustomer

Your customers can use these formats to upload attachments, like receipts or pictures of a damaged item for return processing, and your automations should be able to read and act on them according to what is written in your procedures.

In this article

- How AI Agents use attachments
- Writing procedures that use attachments
- Writing procedures that use tools to act on attachments
- Best practices
- Limitations and considerations

How AI automations use attachments

When a customer sends a message with an attachment, the attachment becomes part of the conversation context available to the AI automation. If the procedure tells the automation to inspect the attachment, it can use the file to along with the customer's message, conversation history, knowledge sources, and available tools to decide how to respond or what action to take next.

Attachments are most useful when the customer needs to provide evidence, context, or structured information that cannot easily be typed into a message.

Common examples include:

Use case	Example customer message	Expected automation behavior
Damaged item return	**"My order arrived broken. I attached a photo."**	**Inspect the image, confirm the item appears damaged, and start the return or replacement procedure.**
Receipt validation	"Here's my receipt."	Review the uploaded receipt and use the order details to determine whether the customer is eligible for a refund or warranty claim.
Troubleshooting	"This is the error I'm	Read the screenshot or document, identify the issue, and provide the next

troubleshooting	seeing."	identify the issue, and provide the next troubleshooting step.
Form or document intake	"I filled out the form and attached it."	Extract relevant information from the file and use a tool to update the customer, conversation, or another record.
Bulk or structured request	"The order IDs are in this spreadsheet."	Review the spreadsheet and follow the procedure for each applicable order, when supported by your configured tools.

Writing procedures that use attachments

When you want an AI automation to act on attachments, write the procedure as explicitly as possible. Do not assume the agent will know which attachment matters, what information to look for, or what to do after reading it.

A strong procedure should tell the automation:

1. **When to inspect the attachment**
2. **What information to look for**
3. **How to decide whether the attachment is valid**
4. **Which tool to use after the attachment has been reviewed**
5. **What to do if the attachment is missing, unreadable, unsupported, or insufficient**

Example: damaged item return

Use a procedure like this when customers upload images of damaged products:

```
 If the customer says an item arrived damaged, check whether they attached an image. 1. Check whether an image is attached. 2. If an image is attached, perform the following actions: 1. Review the image to determine whether it appears to show damage to the item or packaging. 2. If the image appears to show damage, ask for any missing order information required to process the return. 3. If the order information is available, use the return tool to create a replacement or return request. 4. Tell the customer that the request has been started. 3. If no image is attached: 1. Ask the customer to upload a photo of the damaged item or packaging before starting the return. 4. If the image is unclear: 1. Ask the customer to
```

```
before starting the return. 4. If the image is unclear: 1. Ask the customer to upload a clearer photo.
```

Example: receipt or proof-of-purchase review

Use a procedure like this when a customer needs to provide a receipt:

```
If the customer is requesting a warranty claim or reimbursement, check whether they attached a receipt or proof of purchase. 1. From the attachment, look for: 1. Purchase date 2. Store or seller name 3. Order number or transaction ID 4. Product name 5. Total amount paid 2. If the required information is present: 1. Compare the purchase date against the warranty or reimbursement policy. 2. If the request is eligible, use the appropriate tool to create the claim. 3. If the request is not eligible, explain why. 3. If required information is missing or unreadable: 1. Ask the customer to upload a clearer receipt or provide the missing details in the conversation.
```

Example: screenshot-based troubleshooting

Use a procedure like this when a customer uploads a screenshot of an error:

```
1. If the customer attaches a screenshot of an error message: 1. Read the visible error message. 2. Identify the product, page, or workflow where the error occurred, if visible. 3. Search the knowledge base for troubleshooting steps related to that error. 4. Provide the most relevant next step. 2. If the screenshot does not show enough information: 1. Ask the customer what they were trying to do when the error appeared. 2. Ask for any missing account, order, or device details required by the troubleshooting procedure.
```

Writing procedures that use tools to act on attachments

Attachments are often just the first step in many automations, the AI Agent should review the attachment and then use a tool to take action.

For example, after reviewing an attachment, the AI Agent might:

- Create a return
- Start a warranty claim
- Update a customer profile
- Add a conversation note
- Escalate to a team
- Send a message to the customer
- Retrieve order details
- Check policy eligibility

- Create or update an external system record

In AIC 2.0, the agent execution loop can call tools, handle tool outputs, and continue or exit based on the result.

Example: inspect an attachment, then create a return

```
When a customer asks to return an item because it arrived damaged: 1. Check whether the customer attached a photo. 2. If a photo is attached, review it for visible damage. 3. If the photo appears to show damage: 1. Ask for the order number if it is not already available. 2. Use the order lookup tool to confirm the order. 3. Use the return creation tool to start the return. 4. Send the customer a confirmation message. 4. If the photo does not clearly show damage: 1. Ask the customer to upload a clearer image. 5. If no photo is attached: 1. Ask the customer to upload a photo before creating the return.
```

Example: inspect a receipt, then update a customer record

```
When a customer uploads a receipt for reimbursement: 1. Review the receipt attachment. 2. Extract the purchase date, total amount, and transaction ID. 3. If all required fields are present: 1. Use the customer update tool to add the reimbursement details. 2. Use the reimbursement request tool to create the request. 3. Confirm to the customer that the request was submitted. 4. If required fields are missing: 1. Ask the customer to upload a clearer receipt or type the missing information.
```

Best practices

Be specific about the attachment type

Instead of writing:

```
Review the attachment.
```

Write:

```
Review the attached receipt and look for the purchase date, order number, product name, and total amount.
```

Tell the automation what “good enough” means

The AI automation should know when to proceed and when to ask for a better file.

For example:

```
Only create the return if the image clearly shows visible damage to the item or packaging. If the image is blurry, unrelated, or does not show the damaged area, ask the customer to upload a clearer photo.
```

Include a fallback path

Always explain what the automation should do if the attachment cannot be used.

For example:

```
If the file cannot be read, is unsupported, or does not contain the required information, ask the customer to upload a clearer file or provide the required details in the conversation.
```

Use tools only after the procedure's conditions are met

When a procedure includes a tool action, make sure the instructions describe exactly when the automation should use the tool.

For example:

```
Do not create the warranty claim until the receipt shows a purchase date within the warranty period and the product name matches the customer's request.
```

Limitations and considerations

Review these considerations before using attachments in procedures.

File size limits apply

Each channel has its own file size limits. See Understanding attachment size limits for more information. If a customer uploads files that exceed these limits, ask them to upload a smaller file or provide the required information in the conversation.

Supported file types only

Only the supported file types listed at the beginning of this article can be used. If a customer uploads a different file type, ask them to resend the information using a supported format.

Attachment quality matters

The automation can only act on information it can access and interpret. Blurry images, cropped screenshots, password-protected documents, corrupted files, or files with

cropped screenshots, password-protected documents, corrupted files, or files with missing information may not be usable.

Procedures should not rely on attachments alone when policy checks are required

If a policy requires order status, warranty eligibility, shipping status, customer verification, or another system-of-record check, instruct the automation to use the appropriate tool before taking action.

Human review may still be required

Use escalation or human review when the attachment is ambiguous, sensitive, high-value, or when the automation is not confident enough to proceed. Keeping a human in the loop is critical for oversight and optimization of the automation stack.

Be careful with sensitive information

Customers may upload files that contain personal, financial, or other sensitive information. Only ask for attachments that are necessary for the procedure, and avoid asking customers to upload sensitive documents unless your workflow requires them.

Was this article helpful?

YES **NO**

kustomer